



MANUEL BOLAÑOS VALENCIA

Senior Full-Stack Developer · Web Platforms, Integrations & Applied AI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack developer with 15 years of experience and more than 200 projects delivered, building web platforms end to end, from content and e-commerce products to custom business software. My core is PHP, Laravel and WordPress on the back end with React and modern JavaScript on the front, and my strongest specialisation is integration: REST and GraphQL layers that keep CRMs, storefronts, payment providers and third-party platforms in sync. I have led teams as Technical Lead and Scrum Master, and I now build LLM and agent-driven features into production products. Based in Spain, working daily in English with international teams.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Back end: PHP 8, Laravel, WordPress (custom themes, plugins, Gutenberg blocks, ACF, WPGraphQL, headless), October CMS, Node.js, MySQL, PostgreSQL

APIs & integrations: REST and GraphQL API design, SOAP, webhooks and event-driven data flows, OAuth 2.0, API keys and token auth, third-party platform integration

Front end: JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, React, Next.js, Vue, Angular, HTML5, CSS3, Sass with BEM, Bootstrap 5, Tailwind, accessible and responsive UI, hybrid mobile apps (Ionic, PhoneGap)

CRM, e-commerce & marketing: SugarCRM, HubSpot, ActiveCampaign, Constant Contact, Mailchimp, Shopify, VTEX, WooCommerce, payment gateway integration

Applied AI: LLM and agent workflows in production, OpenAI embeddings and vector search (Pinecone, Qdrant, pgvector), prompt engineering, AI-assisted development with Claude Code and MCP servers

Quality & testing: PHPUnit, Pest, PHPStan, PHP CodeSniffer (WPCS), Playwright end-to-end and regression suites, code review

Performance, SEO & compliance: Core Web Vitals and page-speed optimisation, Schema.org structured data, technical SEO, GA4 and Google Tag Manager, Google Consent Mode v2, GDPR and cookie compliance, Content Security Policy

Tooling & delivery: Git and Git Flow, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Composer, npm, Webpack, Google Cloud, Netlify, Vercel, WP Engine, Jira, ClickUp

Ways of working: Scrum (Scrum Master and Product Owner), Agile, technical leadership, mentoring, technical documentation

Languages: Spanish (native), English (professional working proficiency)



WORK EXPERIENCE

Full Stack Developer — TakeOff Media

December 2022 – Present · Remote from Spain · Client: Content Pilot, Dallas, Texas (legal-sector marketing)

- Built more than 10 production WordPress and headless websites end to end and support a portfolio of over 40 live sites on a shared architecture: common theme, Sass and BEM component library, custom Gutenberg blocks and in-house plugins, so a fix is written once and applied everywhere.
- Develop API integration layers on top of WordPress — REST endpoints, GraphQL queries, response normalisation and caching — powering property listing search and filtering, and viewing-scheduling and booking flows kept in sync with third-party reservation systems.
- Run performance audits and optimisation on image- and data-heavy sites, treating Core Web Vitals regressions as defects, and implement GA4 with Google Consent Mode v2, consent platforms, Content Security Policy, Schema.org structured data and technical SEO.
- Set up automated testing and GitHub Actions pipelines with static analysis and coding standards enforced before merge; work in Scrum with developers, tech leads and project managers, and document solutions for live sites.

Stack: WordPress, Genesis Framework, PHP, JavaScript, React, Sass, MySQL, REST, GraphQL, Webpack, GitHub Actions, Playwright, Algolia, LLM integration.

Technical & Operations Leader — Existaya.com

November 2020 – December 2022 · Cali, Colombia

- Led IT operations and a development team as Technical Lead and Scrum Master: processes, estimates, technical design decisions, code reviews and mentoring across web and UX teams, reporting to the COO.
- Owned the company's CRM practice: custom SugarCRM development (modules, workflows, business logic) and REST endpoints connecting the CRM to e-commerce stores, payment gateways, storage services and internal systems, including billing, ticketing and queue-management software for the automotive, security and healthcare sectors.
- Directed e-commerce delivery as the team's main focus: Shopify, VTEX and WooCommerce stores integrated with CRM, payment and fulfilment, plus ActiveCampaign automations keeping contacts, events and sales pipelines in sync.
- Rebuilt an Angular single-page application backed by SugarCRM that ran the service bays of an automotive maintenance centre: appointment scheduling, service and technician assignment, availability and automated customer notifications.
- Ran conversion optimisation programmes: A/B testing, heatmaps and click tracking, and usability sessions, translating findings into interface, accessibility and performance changes.

Stack: PHP, WordPress, Angular, React, October CMS, Shopify, VTEX, WooCommerce, SugarCRM, ActiveCampaign, Sass, MySQL, REST, Elasticsearch.

Project Manager / Technical Leader — Existaya.com

January 2016 – November 2020 · Cali, Colombia

Managed web projects and a five-person development team from requirements through delivery, coordinating Scrum ceremonies and owning scope, quality and deadlines.



Web / UX Developer — Existaya.com

February 2012 – January 2016 · Cali, Colombia

Built responsive websites, user interfaces and hybrid mobile apps with Ionic and PhoneGap, using HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, jQuery and WordPress, with performance and usability testing alongside real users.

Web Developer — EME

January 2011 – December 2011 · Cali, Colombia

Developed and maintained client websites in HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, PHP and WordPress.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Semantic search for a client platform — Designed a vector-based search capability using OpenAI embeddings and a vector store, decoupled from the existing search provider, evaluating Pinecone, Qdrant and pgvector against the client's operating and cost constraints.

AI-assisted development workflow — Maintain per-project convention files, custom commands and MCP servers (GitHub, MySQL, filesystem, Playwright, Figma) plus a personal utilities repository, used daily to speed up delivery without shipping code I cannot explain.

Embedded systems and IoT (personal) — ESP32 projects in C and C++: sensor and display integration over SPI and I²C, and a 4WD exploration rover with custom suspension, motor drivers and a self-designed chassis.

EDUCATION

CECEP Technology University — Cali, Colombia · 2012–2015

Degree, Systems Technologist / Software Developer

FADP Institute — Cali, Colombia · 2008–2011

Degree, Graphic & Web Design

ICESI University — Cali, Colombia · 2016

Diploma, Project Management (PMI)

CECEP Technology University — Cali, Colombia · 2015

Diploma, Information Security / Project Management

Continuous learning — Platzi and Udemy (Laravel, WordPress, React, Angular, JavaScript ES6, Git, MySQL, Shopify, VTEX); self-directed embedded systems path (CS50x, C/C++, Arduino, ESP32).